Volunteer scheduling at Oakfield Food Bank

- 180DC · Deliverable 2

Executive summary

- Shift coverage is slipping as volunteer numbers grow

- A three-month pilot will test the app with two shift teams.

- We recommend a volunteer booking app

Project scope

- How can coordinators fill shifts with less effort?

Approach

- 6 coordinator interviews

- 12 volunteer survey responses

- 3 scheduling tools compared

Section 1 · Situation

What coordinators told us

- Coordinators spend about 4 hours a week chasing replies

- Last-minute gaps are filled by the same few people

Shift coverage

- 30% of shifts are unfilled at least once a month

- Gaps cluster on weekday mornings

Volunteer demographics

- Age bands

- Years volunteering

Volunteer attitudes

- Most volunteers would use an app (9 of 12 surveyed)

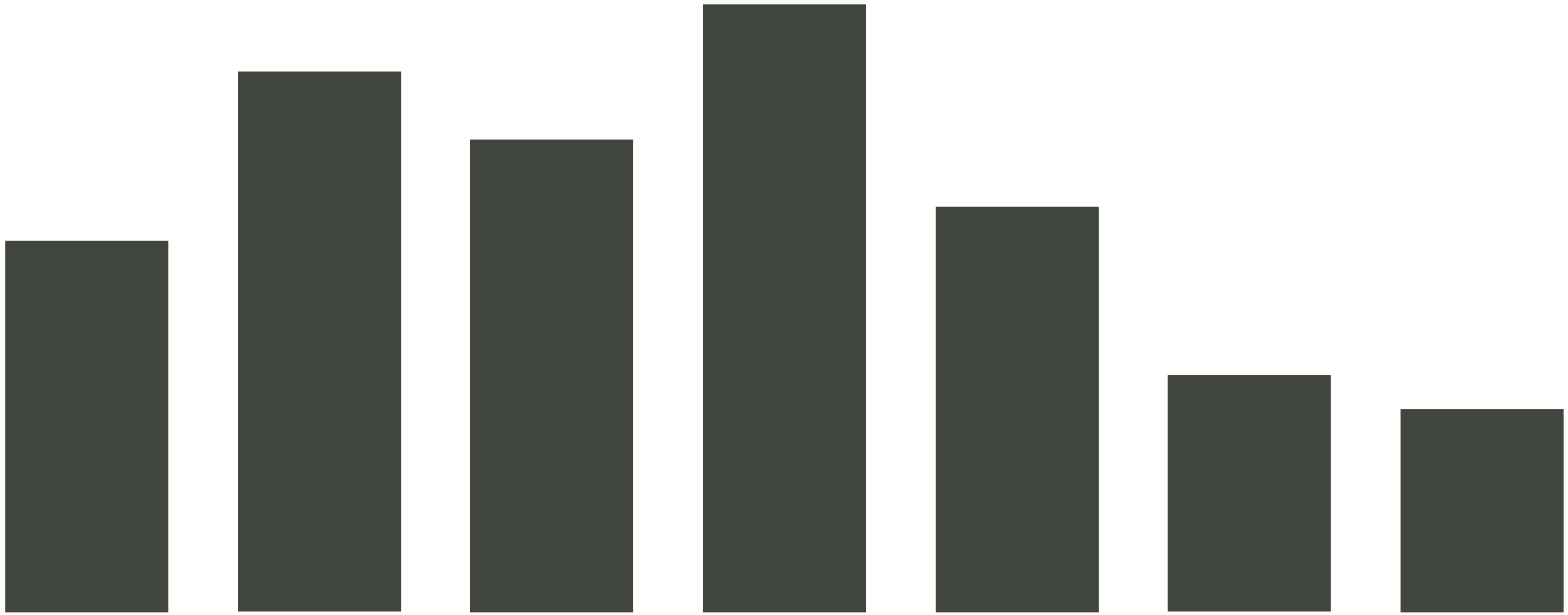
- Reminders were the most wanted feature

Current tools

- WhatsApp group

- Paper rota on the warehouse wall

Weekly demand against volunteers



Option comparison: WhatsApp, shared spreadsheet, booking app

- Cost · effort · reach

Section 3 · Recommendation

Recommendation

- We recommend adopting a volunteer booking app.

- Automated reminders

- Self-service shift swaps

Next steps

- Next steps: explore options with the board

Thank you

- Questions?

Appendix A · Survey method

- Survey sent to the volunteer WhatsApp group

- 12 responses over two weeks

Appendix B · Interview guide